Streamline finance workflows with iterative prompting

AI FOR FINANCE

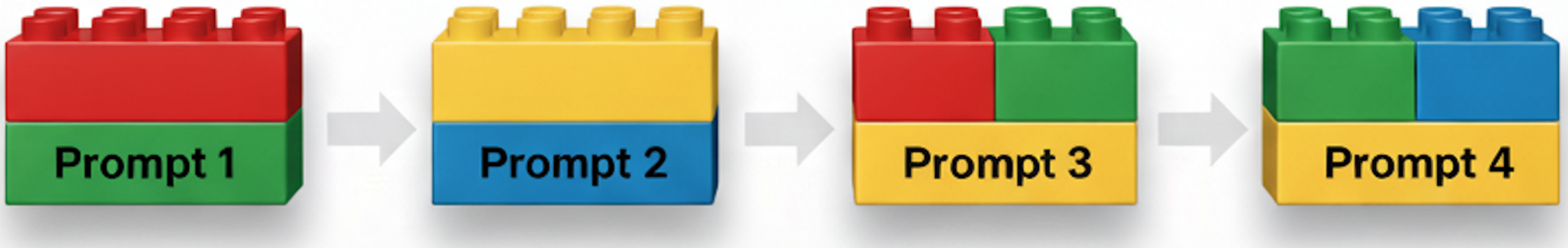


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Head of AI, VAI Consulting

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From prompts to workflows

- In finance, answers build on each other - workflows help manage these connected steps
- With AI, structured prompt sequences turn complex tasks into clear, repeatable workflows



- Fewer errors, clearer reasoning trail, more control over

Step by step


04
draft an executive summary
03
compare with stock data
02
extract metrics and claims
01
summarize tone

Making workflows reusable

Use placeholders for inputs:



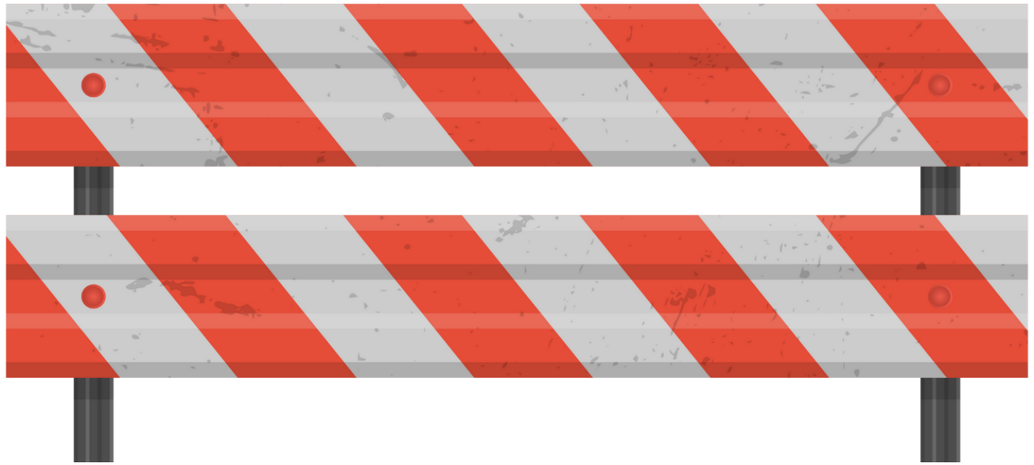
- Same process, *any* company
- One adaptable workflow

Acceptance criteria

Aim: Consistent and audit-ready outputs

Acceptance criteria = explicit rules that enforce structure and quality

Guardrails for prompts and workflows



Examples include:

- Bullet lists for extracted metrics
- Transcript citations for every claim
- An executive summary that is exactly three paragraphs
- Ending with three open questions for management

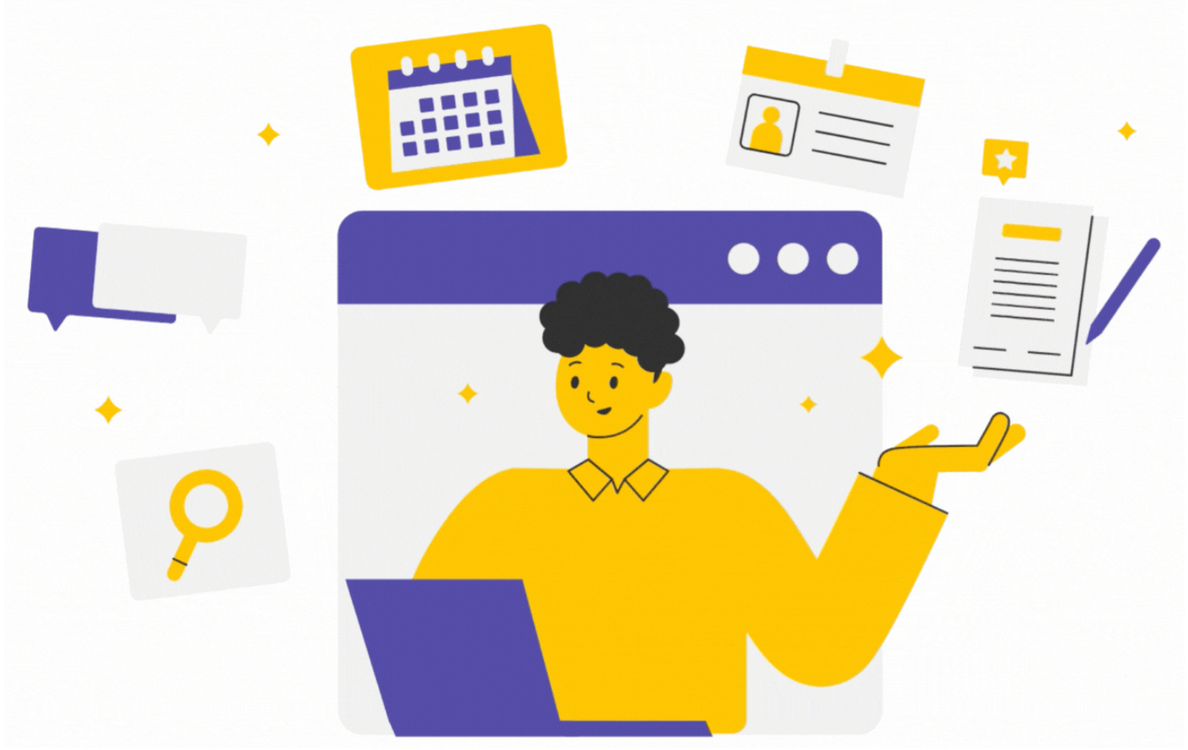
Refinement

The process of reviewing and polishing outputs

- `Make the summary more concise.`
- `Use a formal finance tone.`
- `Add three bullet points on risks`



The payoff



Combining **multi-step prompting**, **reusable workflows**, **refinement**, and an understanding of **augmentation versus automation**:

- Reduce editing time
- Enable quarter-to-quarter comparisons
- Scale across companies and industries

Let's practice!

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Building custom finance assistants

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So far, so good

- How to structure prompts
- Set custom instructions
- Schedule recurring queries

Build a dedicated AI assistant

- Research, analyze, and communicate finance insights consistently



Too much context, too little time

Task: Update on earnings results, market news, and ESG actions



Structured prompt: one-time request with a clear question, data, and format

Custom instructions: persistent guidelines that shape how AI answers every prompt

Both improve quality, but remain manual

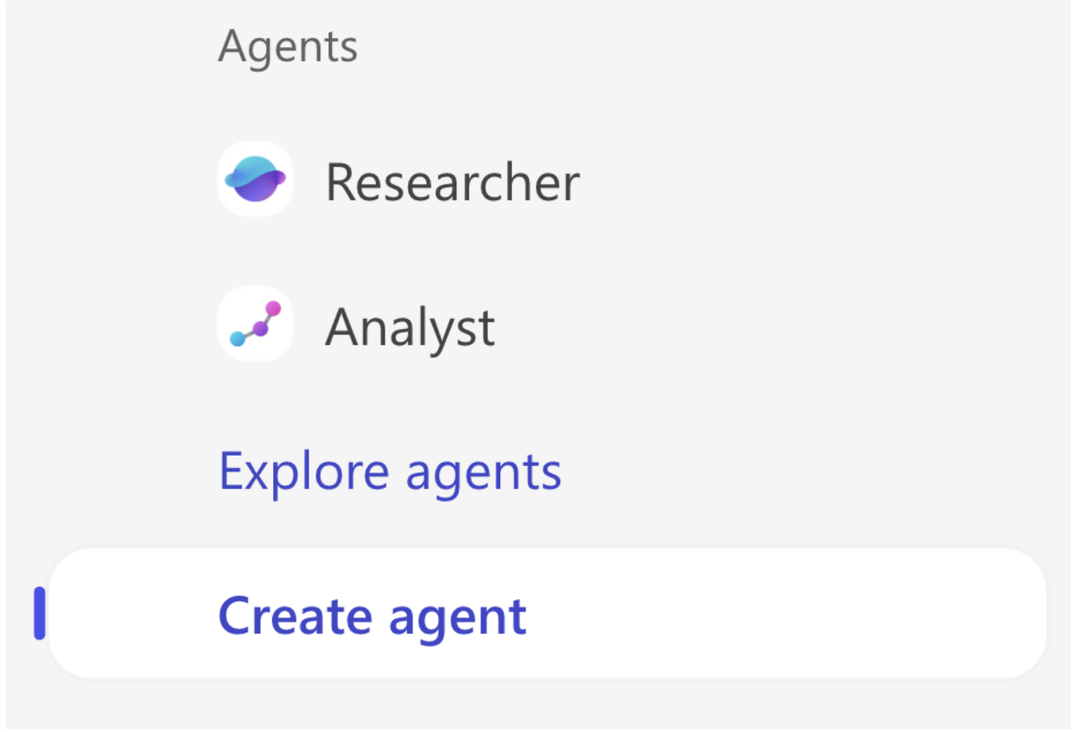
AI assistants

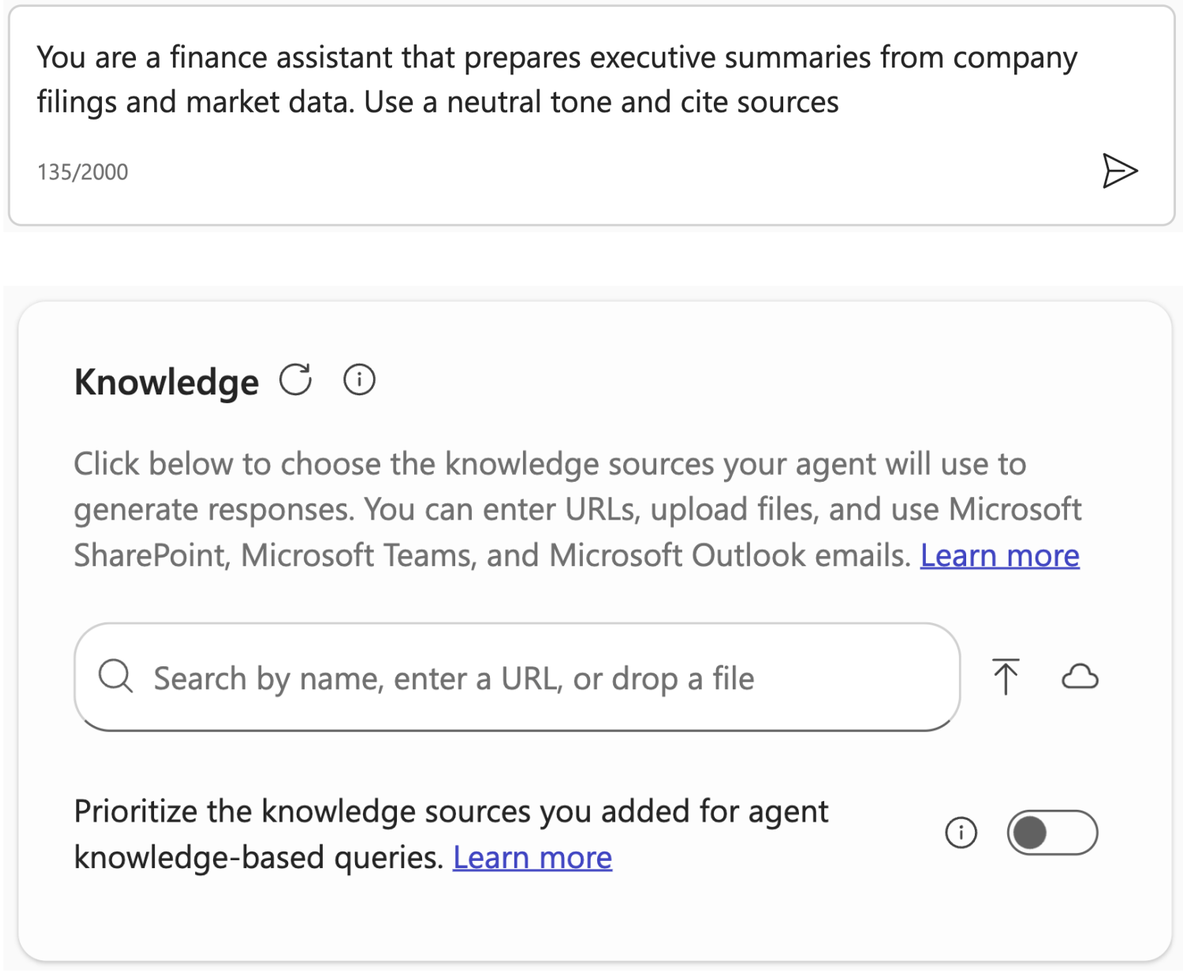
Assistants:

- Maintain structure
- Add memory and reusable context
- Can access knowledge or reference files
- Save time and improve reliability
- Stay consistent

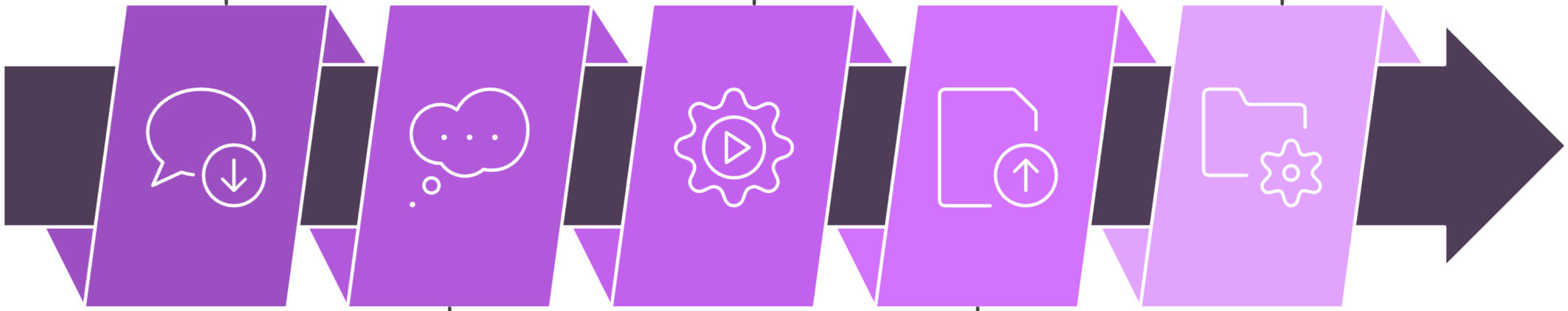


Setup





Define a **role**, add **knowledge**, and **reuse**



Open a New Copilot Chat

Initiate a new chat session with Copilot

Write a Natural Language Prompt

Describe the assistant's role and task in natural language

Add Instructions

Specify tone, structure, and sourcing guidelines

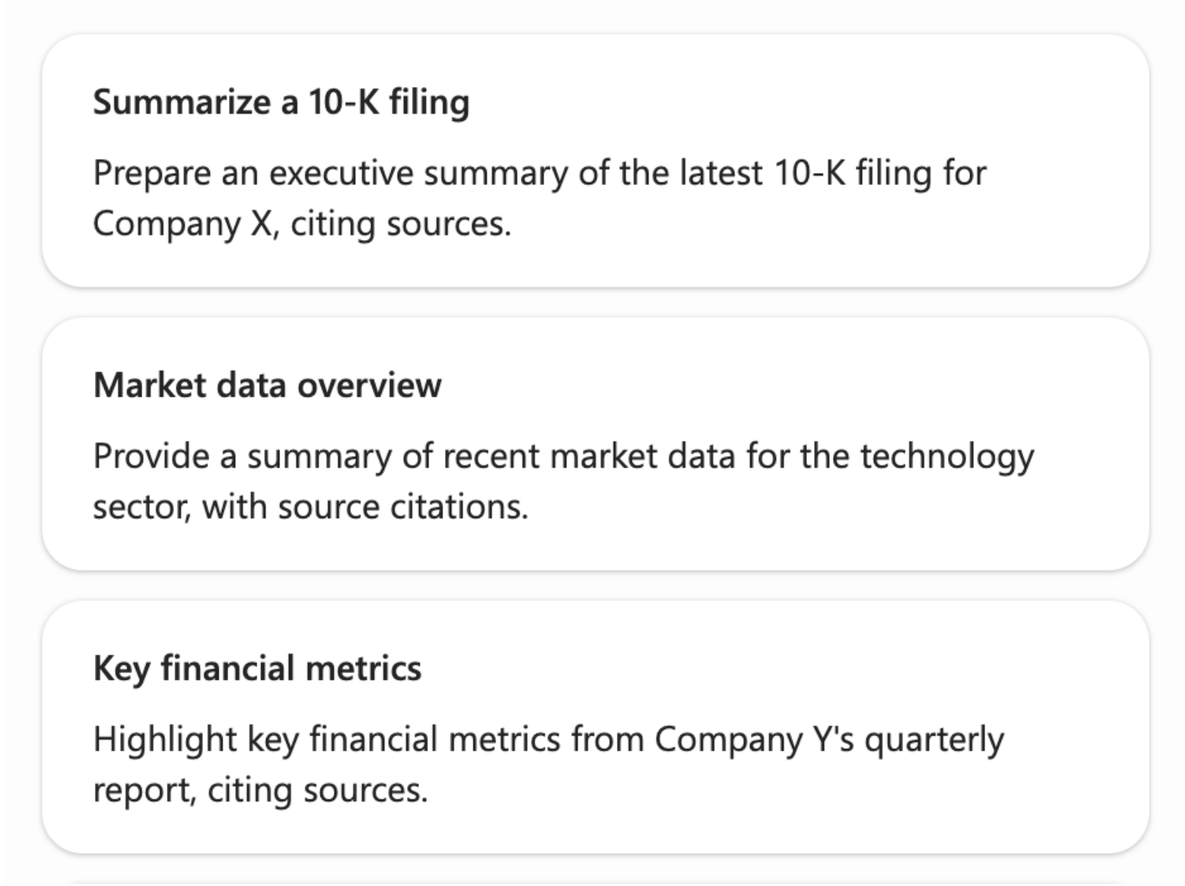
Upload Reference Files

Provide relevant documents or datasets

Save Setup

Save the configuration for future use

Working with your assistant



Get started easily

- Try suggested conversation starters or guided prompts
- Begin with simple finance questions or summaries

Put it to work

- Process uploaded files instantly
- Generate summaries, analyses, or evaluations
- Receive tailored outputs

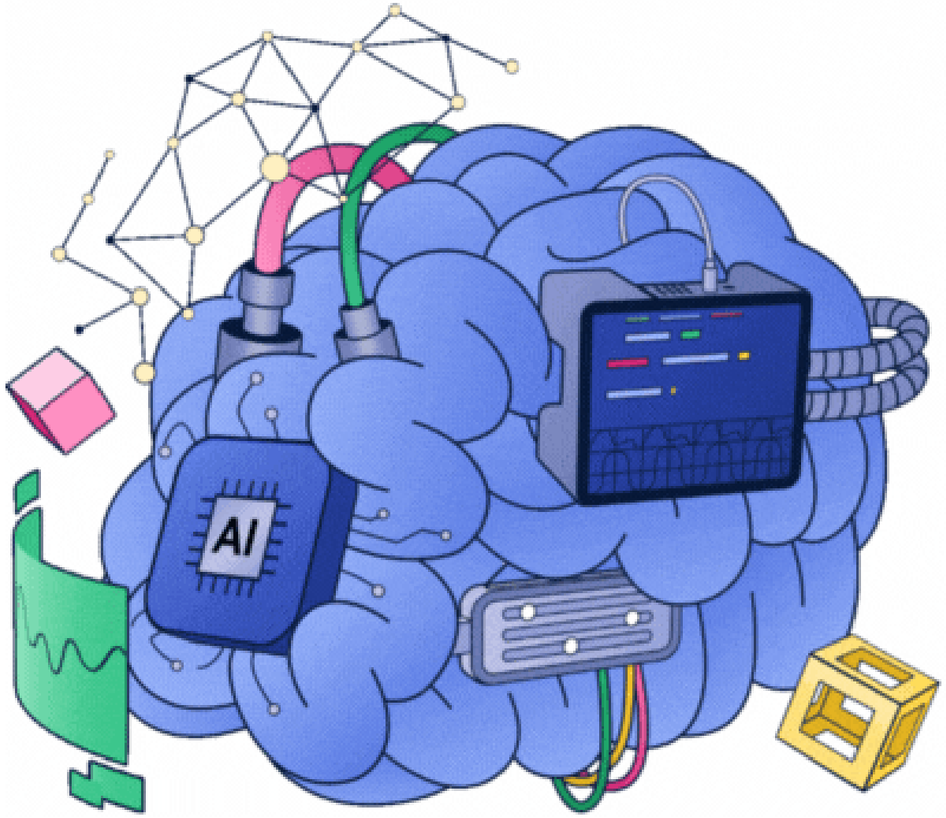
Knowledge files and integrations

Add knowledge with files

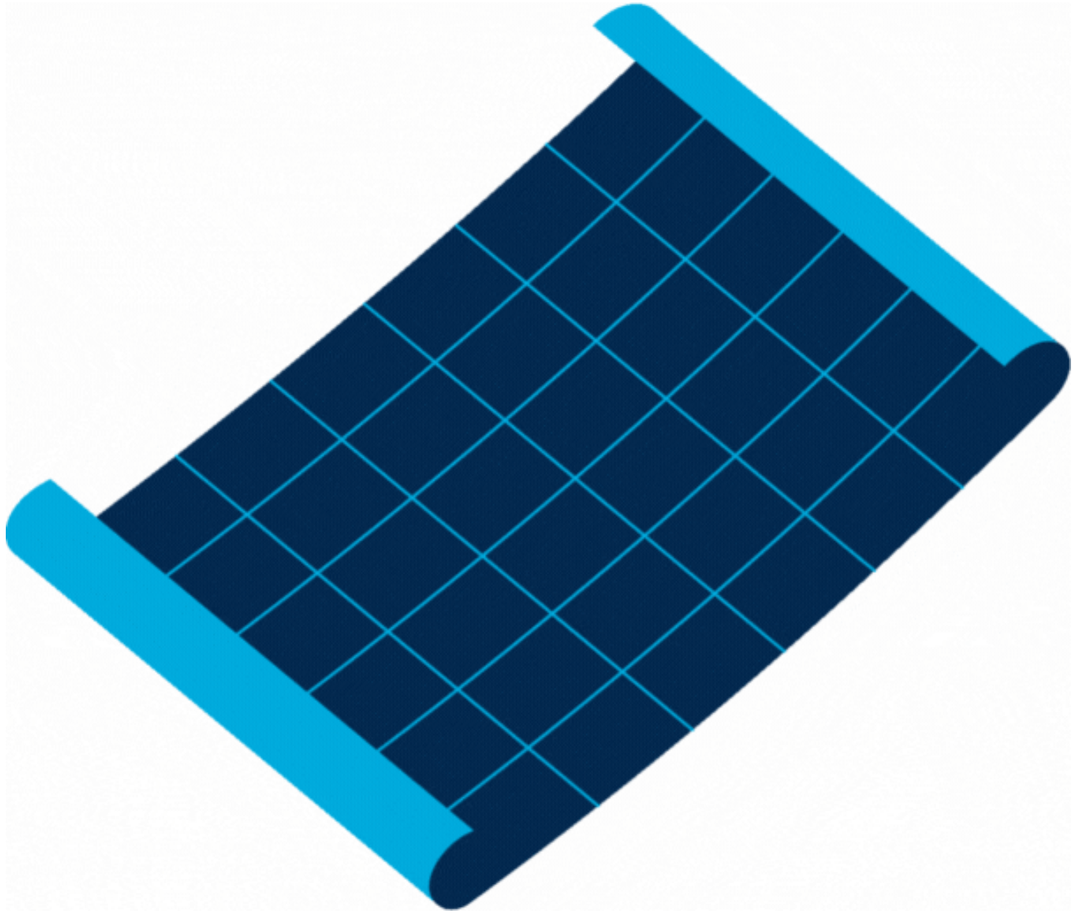
- Upload reports and forecasts for context
- Transforms your assistant into a specialized Copilot agent
- Delivers accurate, compliant, and relevant outputs

Extend with integrations

- Connect to compatible tools
- Work securely within your organization's ecosystem



Building practices



- Start small with one clear task
- Keep instructions concise and measurable
- Use trusted, current files for accuracy
- Refresh context when data changes
- **Always verify** outputs before sharing

Combine **structured prompts, custom instructions,** and **knowledge files**



Extend with **integrations**

Let's practice!

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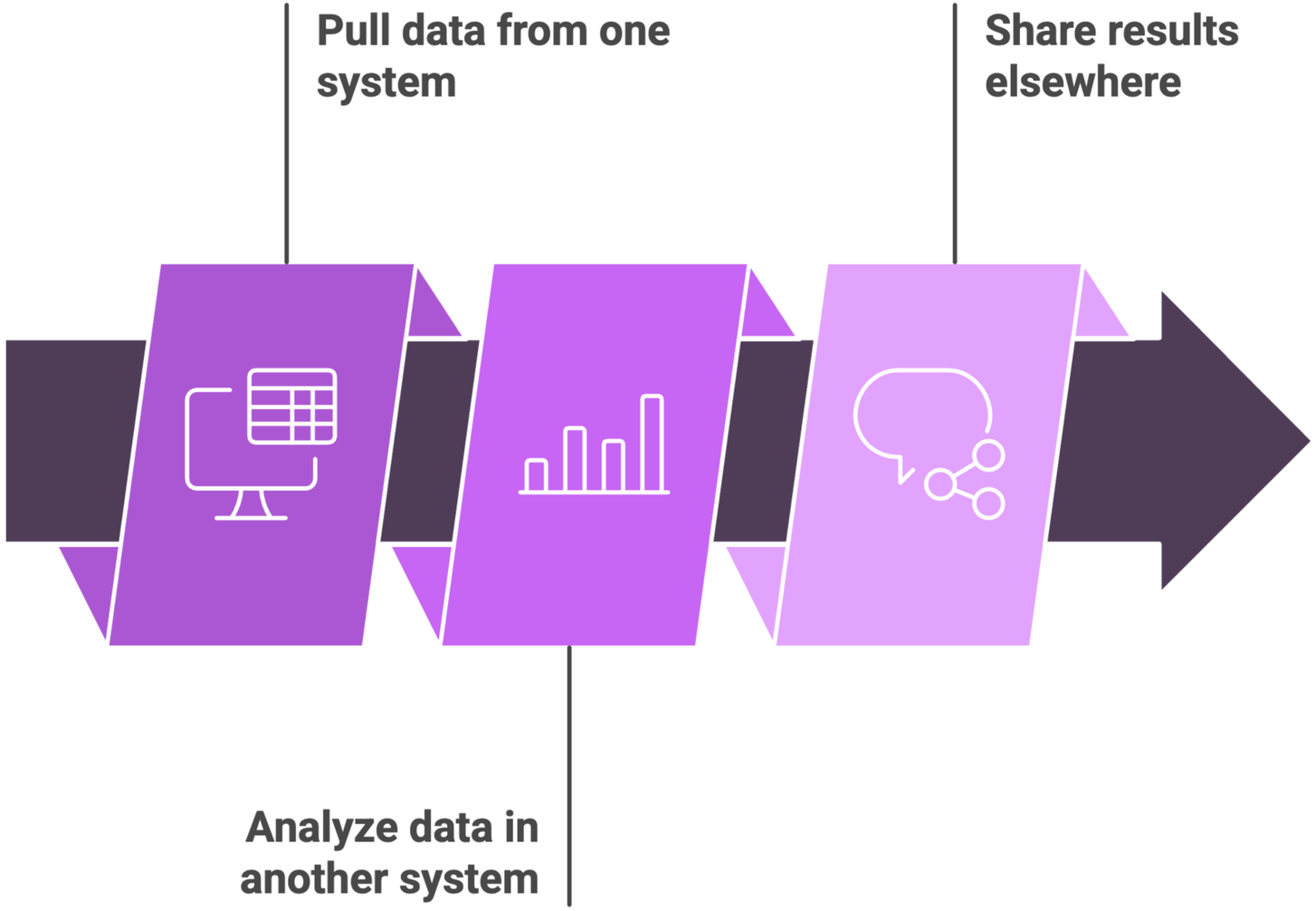
From augmentation to automation

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Pull data from one system
Share results elsewhere
Analyze data in another system

How finance gets smarter

Efficiency through systems

- In finance, real efficiency comes from systems, not just analysis

AI + automation = streamlined finance

- Combine language models with workflow automation
- Simplify everything from data collection to reporting and decisions

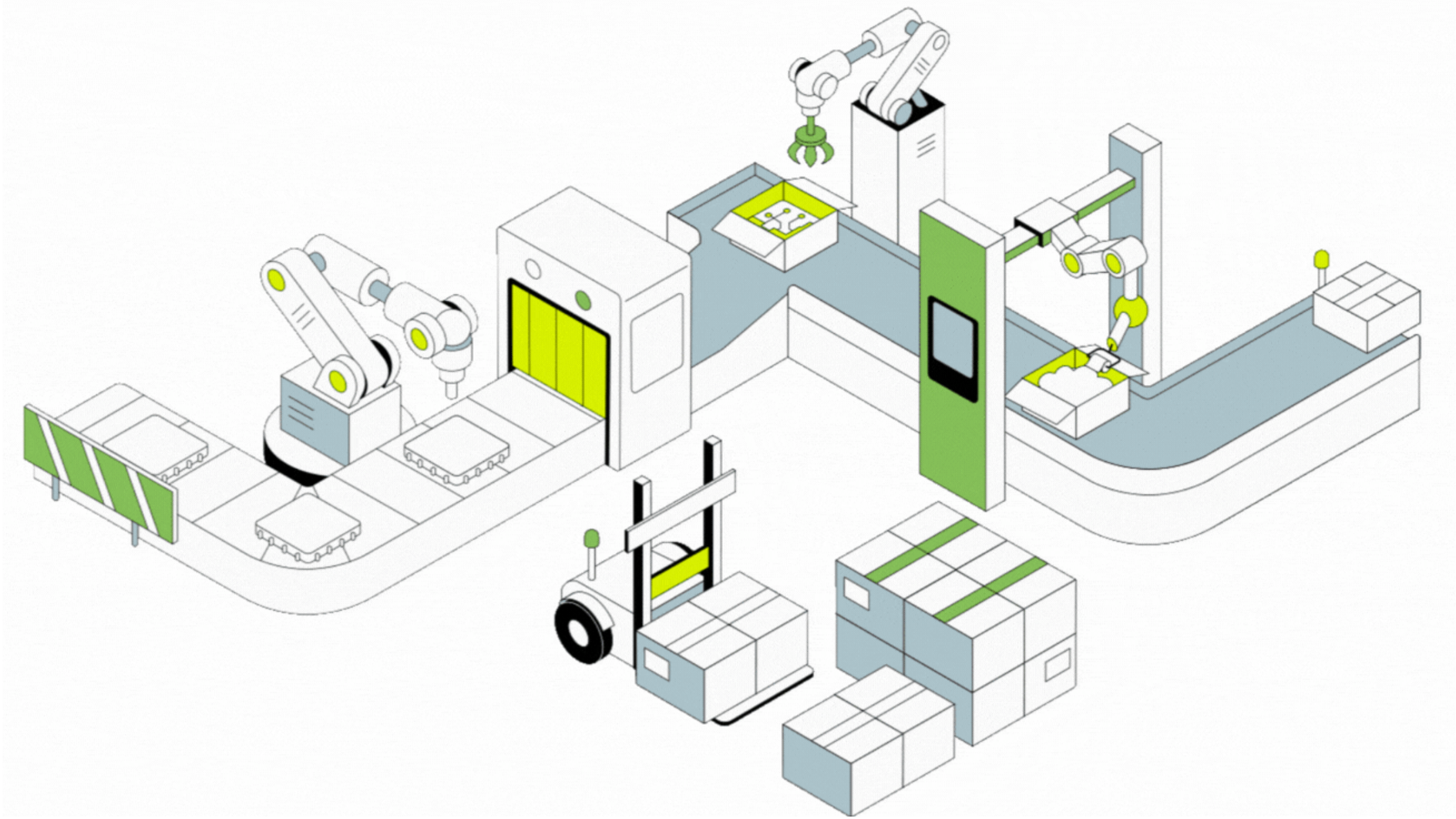
Think in systems, not steps

- See how each change affects the whole process



- Learn the mindset for scalable, transparent, real-world AI workflows

The production line



Before

Manual month-end close

- Download data from ERP - Excel - Word - Email
- Manually clean, calculate, and recheck links
- Hours lost to repetition and formatting
- Limited visibility and version control

After

Connected AI-assisted workflow

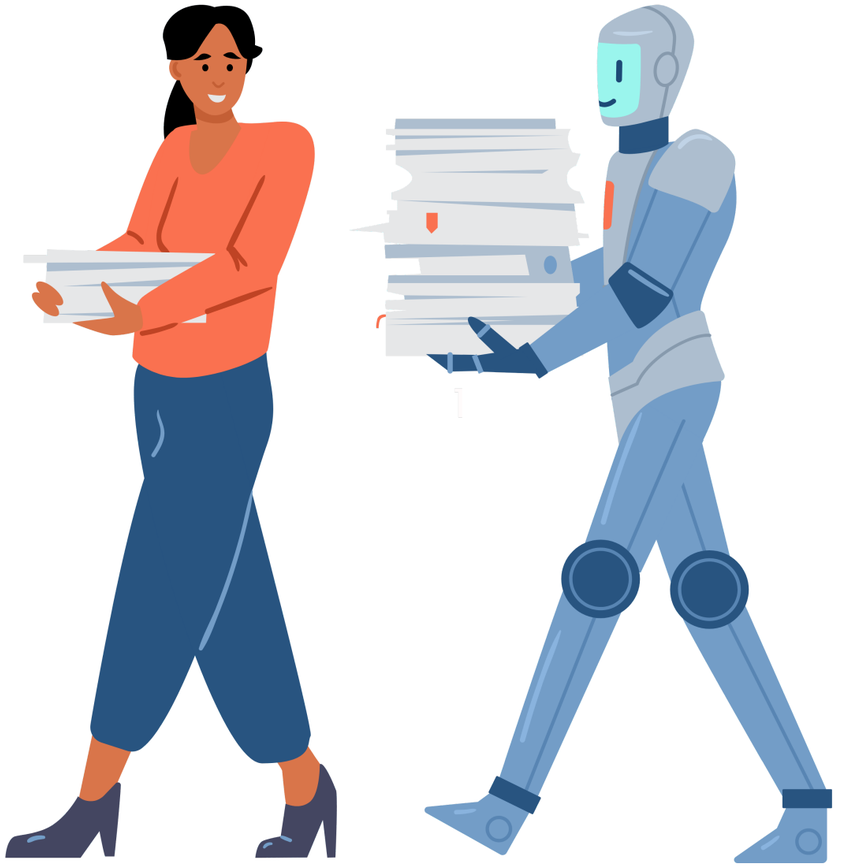
- Extract your ERP data on a schedule
- Use an AI system to validate the inputs
- Use another AI system to draft commentary, and have an approval process before sharing with stakeholders

Stages flow seamlessly from data -> decision

Workflows in finance

- Forecasting
- Variance analysis
- Anomaly detection
- Compliance and more

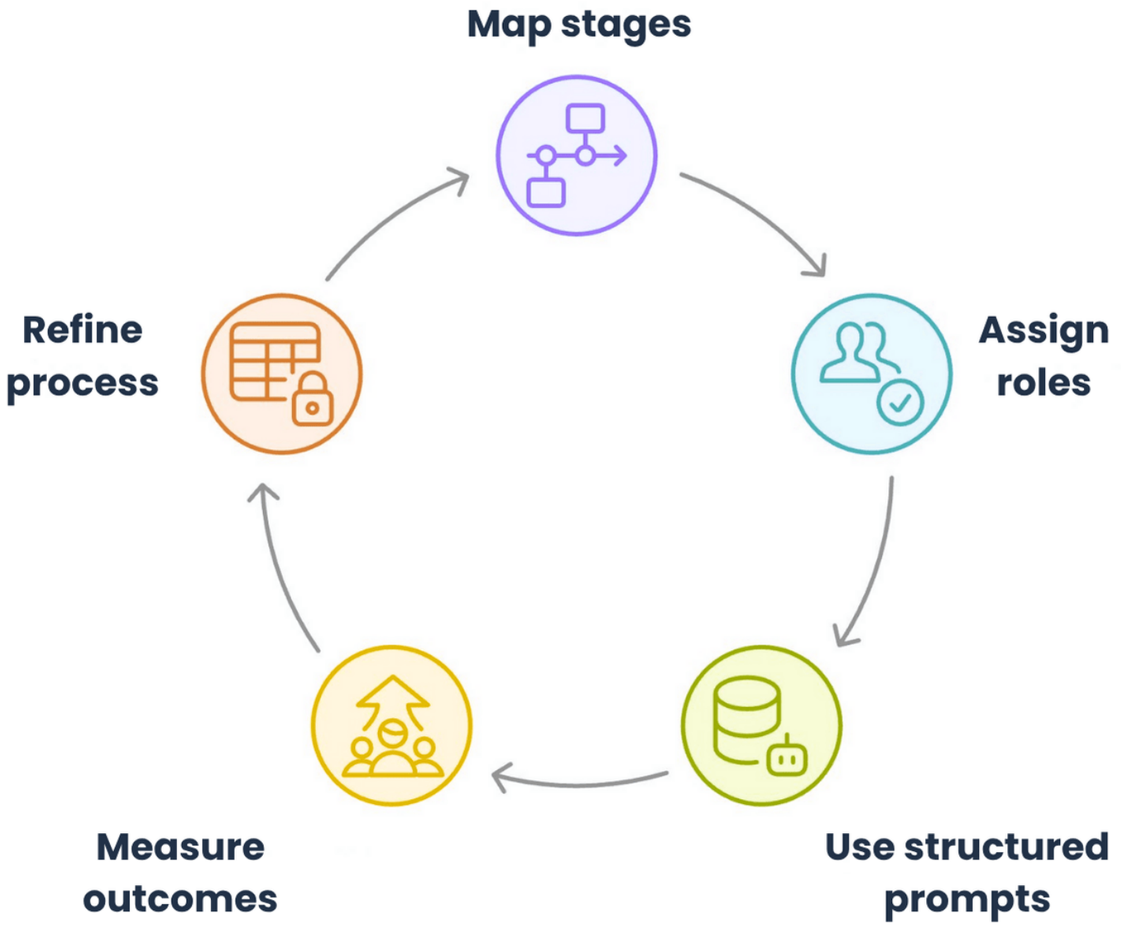
AI assists with **structured**, **repetitive** steps, while humans focus on **reasoning** and **storytelling**



Best practices

1. Map the main stages
2. Assign roles
3. Use structured prompts
4. Measure and refine

Build finance workflows that are **efficient**, **auditable**, and **human-centered**



Scale and impact

Workflows can be small or large

- Small and personal: reconciling expenses with chatbots and file uploads
- Large and enterprise-wide: AI forecasting in SAP
- Different scales, same purpose



Smarter, **faster**, and more **resilient**

Let's practice!

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Congratulations

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Chapter 1

- Designed reusable prompts
- Structured context, task, data, and output
- Built simple reusable prompts that deliver consistent results

Chapter 2

- Shaped outputs with custom instructions
- Scheduled prompts for ESG and regulatory updates
- Verified sources and turned news into clear takeaways

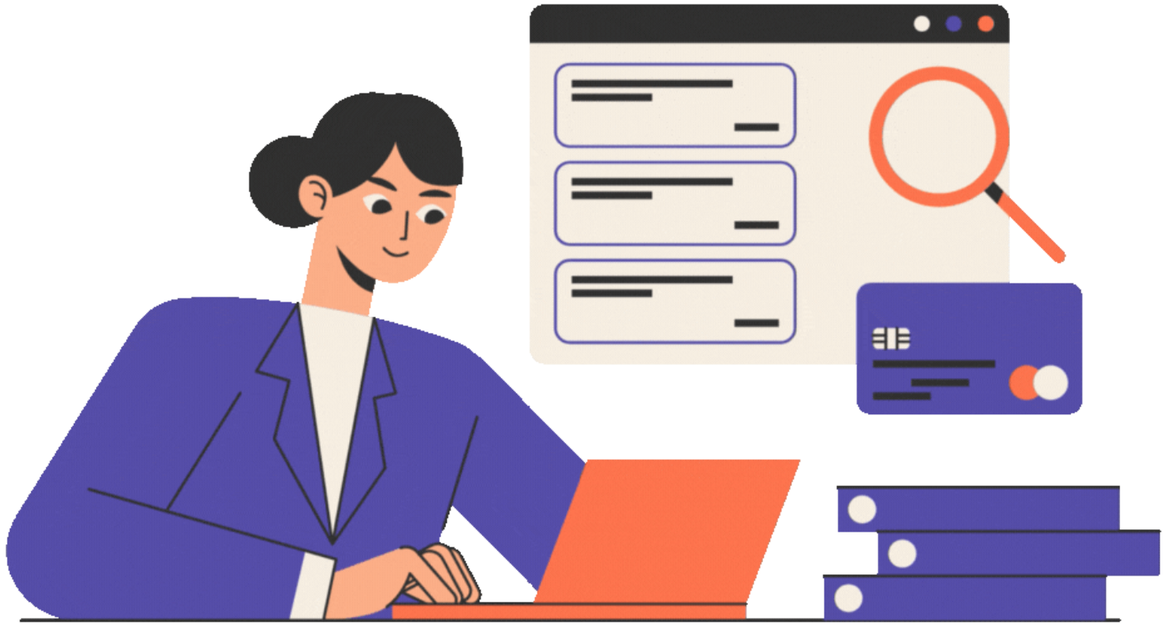
Chapter 3

- Learned how to think in systems
- Kept humans in the loop for accountability
- Built a custom finance assistant



From tasks to systems

- Turn individual tasks into connected systems and workflows
- Apply your workflows across forecasting, variance reporting, fraud, compliance, ESG and more
- Start small, keep humans in control, refine continuously



Thank you

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